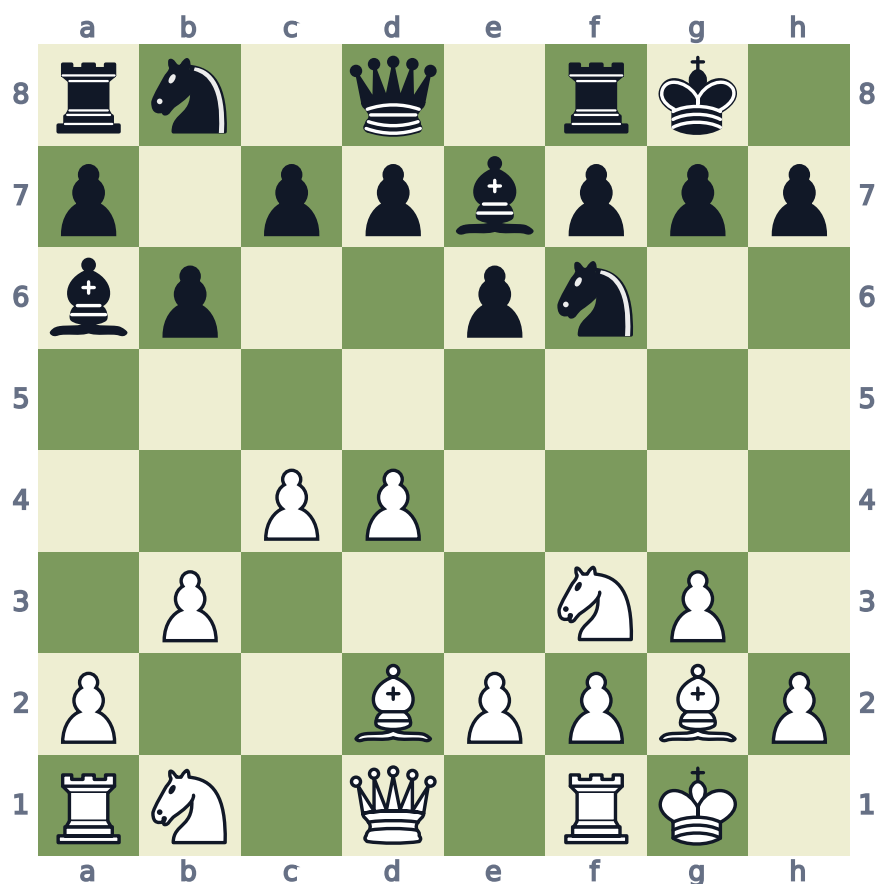


Queen's Indian, Bogo-Indian, and Move Orders

Avoiding the Nimzo, controlling e4, and meeting ...Bb4+ and ...b6



Use 3.Nf3 intelligently, understand what it avoids, and meet Black's flexible e4-control systems without losing direction.

8 learning units | diagrams | recall tests | engine-checked analysis

ORIENTATION

How to study this volume

PURPOSE

Use 3.Nf3 intelligently, understand what it avoids, and meet Black's flexible e4-control systems without losing direction.

THE TRAINING LOOP

- First identify Black's defense from pawn placement and move order.
- At every diagram, name the center, the urgent threat, and two candidate moves.
- Hide the recall answer until you have spoken the move and its purpose.
- Replay each line from both sides in Fritz or another board program.
- Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.
-

WHAT COMPLETE MEANS HERE

This volume contains 8 units inside a connected White repertoire. It covers the main structural and move-order decisions you need for practical play; the PGN companion makes later updating possible.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 1-3

PRINCIPLE 1

3.Nf3 avoids the Nimzo-Indian while keeping Catalan and Queen's Indian options.

PRINCIPLE 2

The b7 bishop often targets e4 before it attacks the king.

PRINCIPLE 3

A check on b4 changes White's development square, not necessarily the evaluation.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 4-6

PRINCIPLE 4

White can answer ...Ba6 with b3, Qc2, or Nbd2 depending on tactics.

PRINCIPLE 5

Do not force e4 until the square is adequately supported.

PRINCIPLE 6

Flexible move orders still require a planned pawn break.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

REPERTOIRE MAP

Branches 1-8

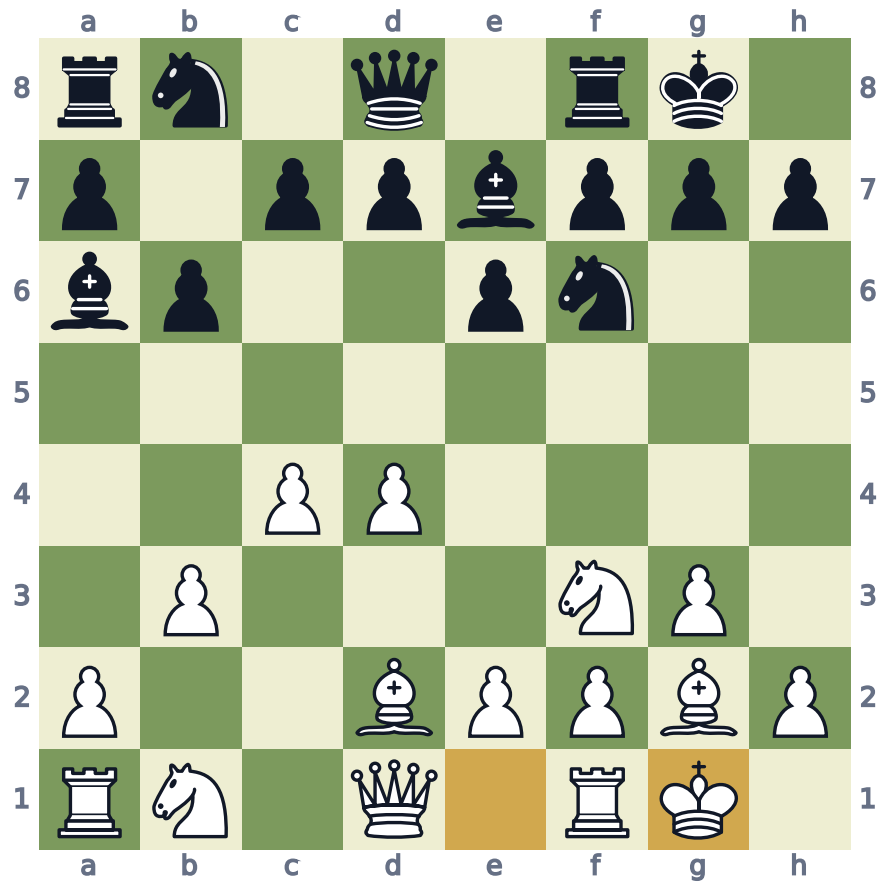
- | | | |
|-----------|-------------------------------|---|
| 01 | Queen's Indian ...Ba6 | ...Ba6 attacks c4 and interferes with natural queenside development. |
| 02 | Queen's Indian ...Bb7 | The b7 bishop and e4 knight form Black's central control team. |
| 03 | Queen's Indian ...Bb4+ | After a bishop trade, reorganize development rather than mourning a tempo. |
| 04 | Bogo-Indian ...Qe7 | Keep the bishop if it has a future role; exchange only for a concrete gain. |
| 05 | Bogo-Indian ...a5 | ...a5 supports the bishop but also spends a tempo away from the center. |
| 06 | Bogo-Indian ...Bxd2+ | Qxd2 keeps the knight flexible and connects to c3/e3. |
| 07 | Blumenfeld Gambit | ...b5 plus ...e6 sacrifices a wing pawn to build a central mass. |
| 08 | Nimzo avoidance | If you want to avoid the Nimzo, play Nf3 before Nc3 after ...e6. |

NAVIGATION RULE

Identify the pawn structure first, then confirm the move order. A familiar position reached by a different sequence should trigger the same plan.

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 01

Queen's Indian ...Ba6



COURSE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 b6 4. g3 Ba6 5. b3 Bb4+ 6. Bd2 Be7 7. Bg2 O-O 8. O-O

WHITE'S IDEA

Use b3 to protect c4 and force the bishop to declare its purpose.

MAIN DANGER

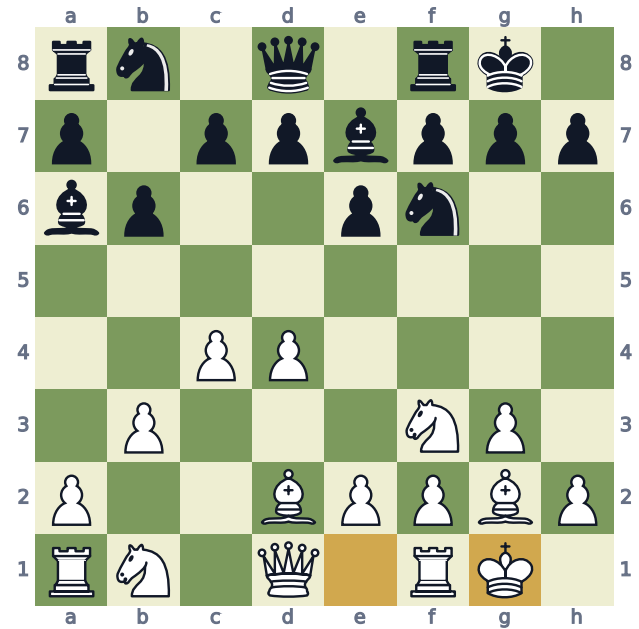
b3 weakens dark squares if White later loses the g2 bishop.

BRANCH LOGIC 01

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

...Ba6 attacks c4 and interferes with natural queenside development.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

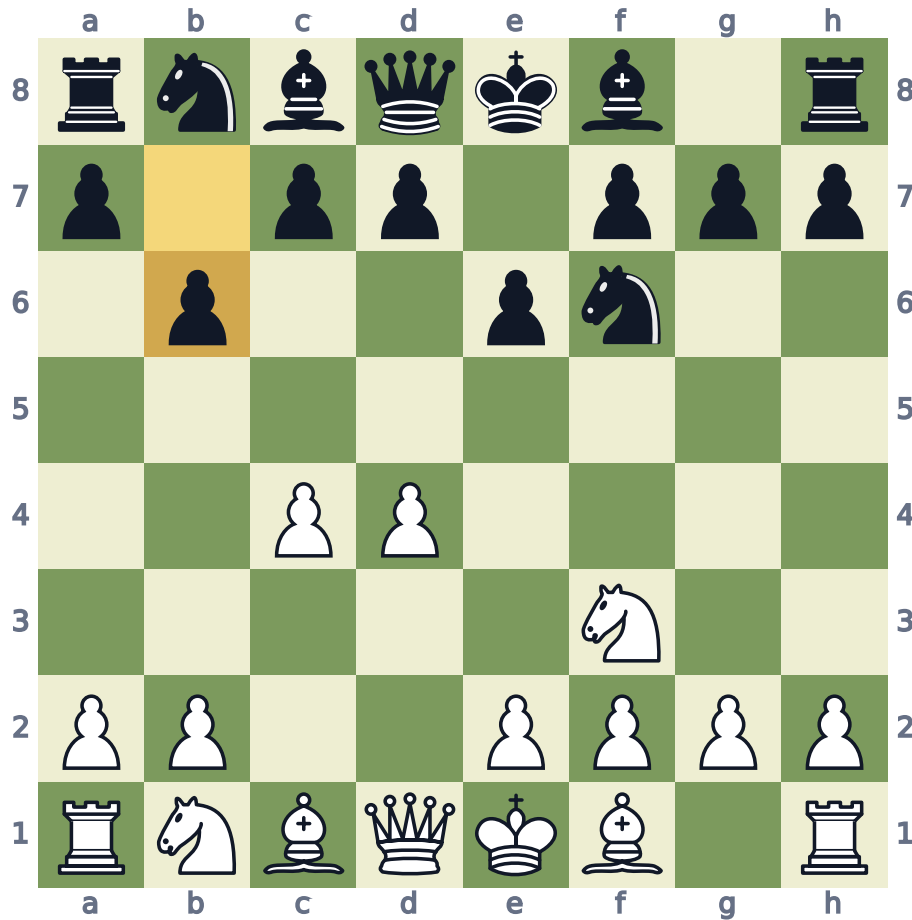
Position estimate: +0.38 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. c6 Qc2 2. d5 Ne5 3. dxc4 bxc4 4. Qxd4 Bc3 5. Qd6 Nd2

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 01

Queen's Indian ...Ba6



YOUR TASK

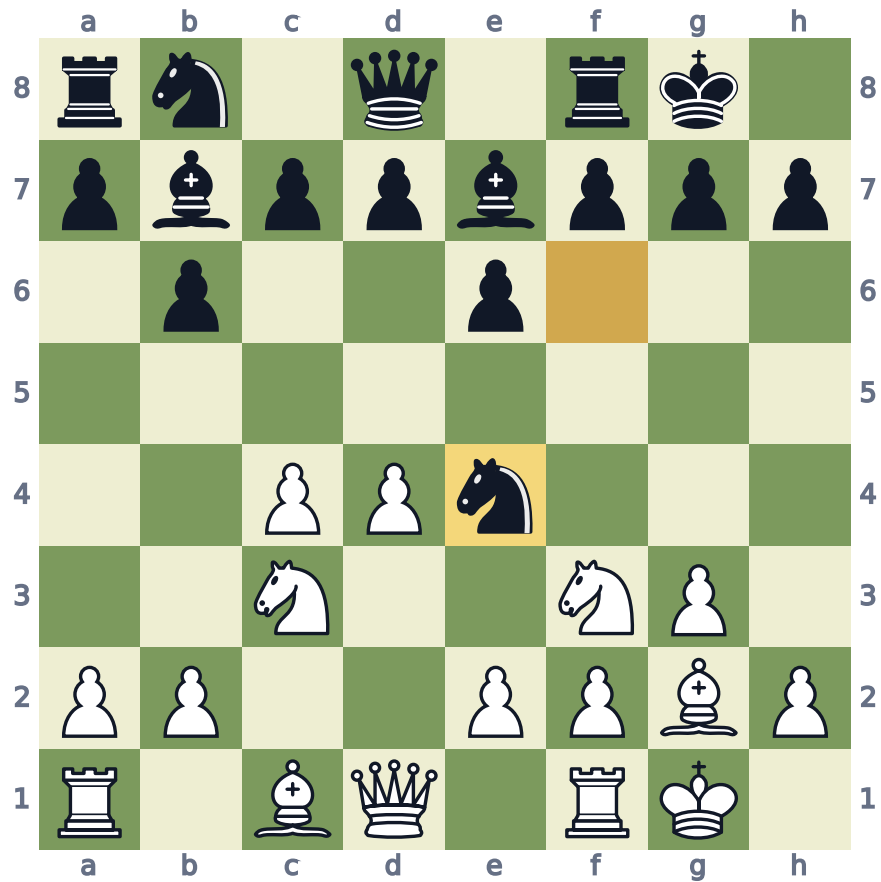
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 02

Queen's Indian ...Bb7



COURSE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 b6 4. g3 Bb7 5. Bg2 Be7 6. O-O O-O 7. Nc3 Ne4

WHITE'S IDEA

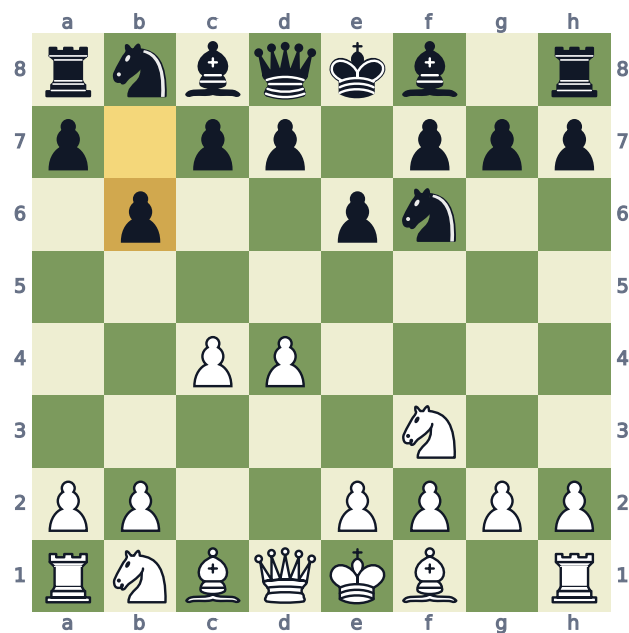
Finish development and test the centralized knight before occupying e4.

MAIN DANGER

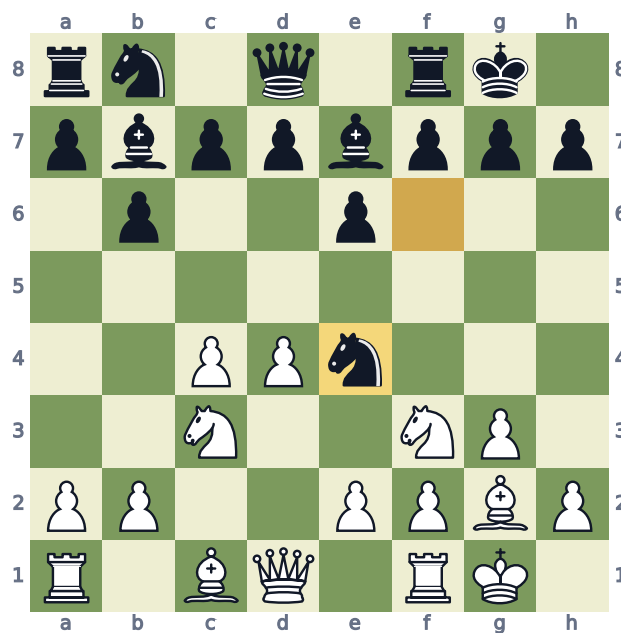
Careless d5 can leave c5 and e5 weak.

BRANCH LOGIC 02

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

The b7 bishop and e4 knight form Black's central control team.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

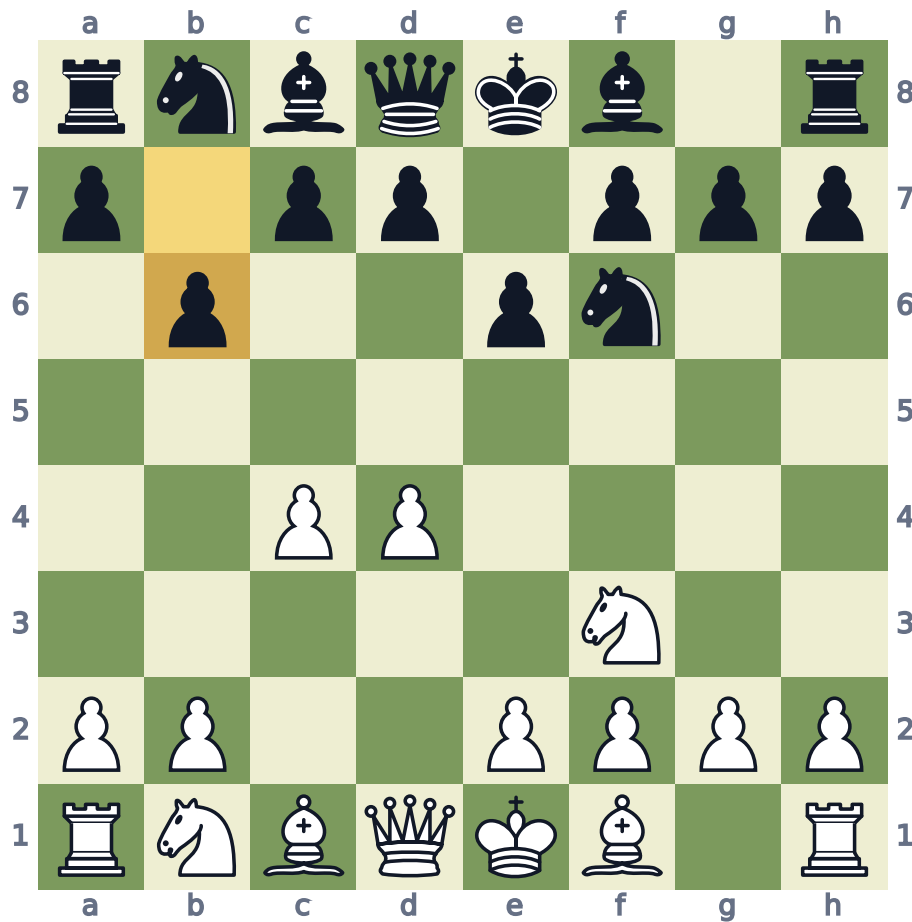
Position estimate: +0.41 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bd2 d5 2. cxd5 exd5 3. Qc2 Nd7 4. Rfd1 Rc8 5. Ne5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 02

Queen's Indian ...Bb7



YOUR TASK

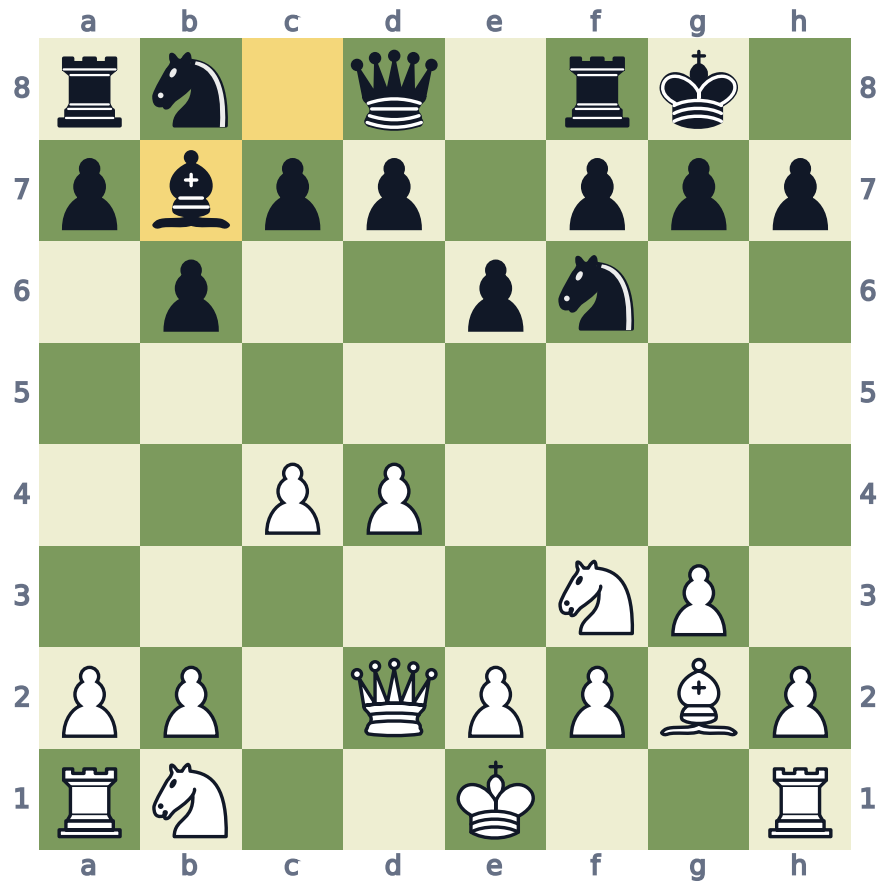
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 03

Queen's Indian ...Bb4+



COURSE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 b6 4. g3 Bb4+ 5. Bd2 Bxd2+ 6. Qxd2 O-O 7. Bg2 Bb7

WHITE'S IDEA

Accept a useful queen placement and retain the bishop pair.

MAIN DANGER

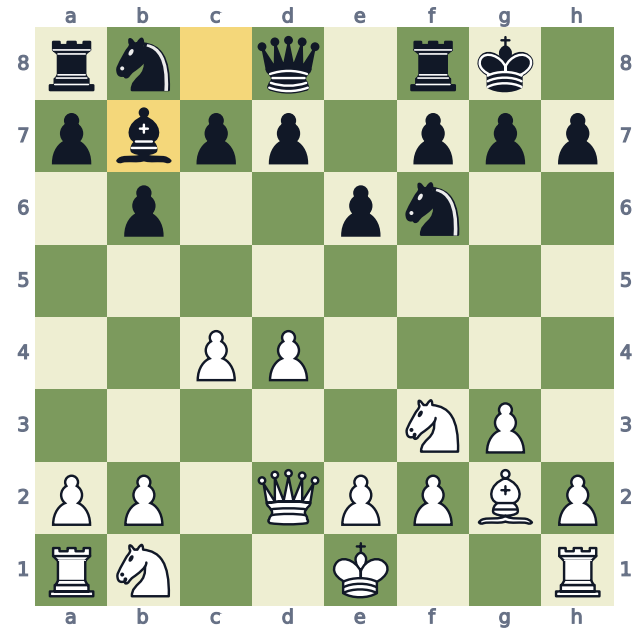
The queen on d2 can block the b1 knight and invite ...Ne4.

BRANCH LOGIC 03

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

After a bishop trade, reorganize development rather than mourning a tempo.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

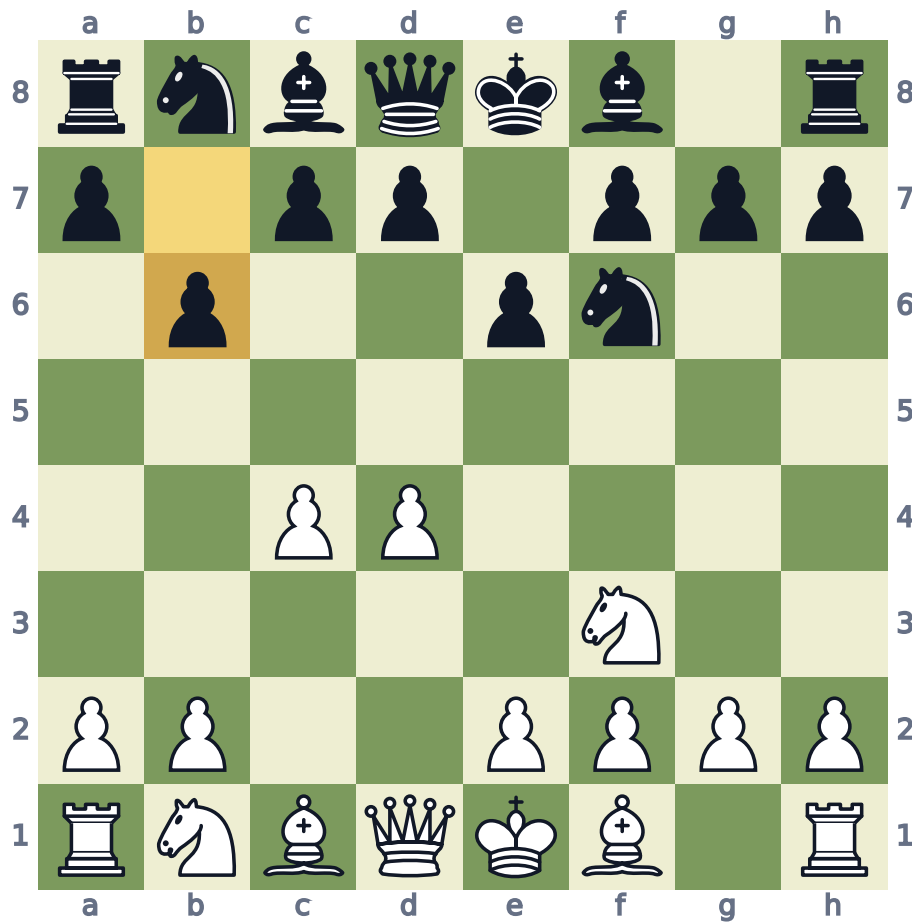
Position estimate: +0.48 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nc3 Ne4 2. Nxe4 Bxe4 3. Qe3 d5 4. O-O Nd7 5. cxd5 exd5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 03

Queen's Indian ...Bb4+



YOUR TASK

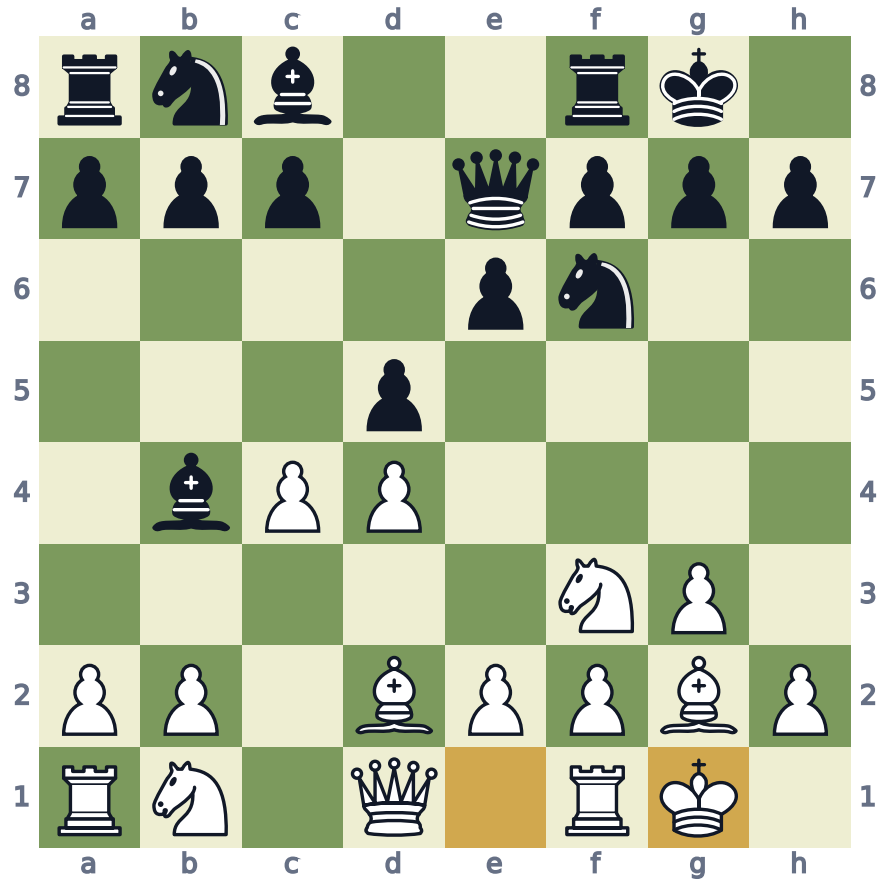
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 04

Bogo-Indian ...Qe7



COURSE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 Bb4+ 4. Bd2 Qe7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 d5 7. O-O

WHITE'S IDEA

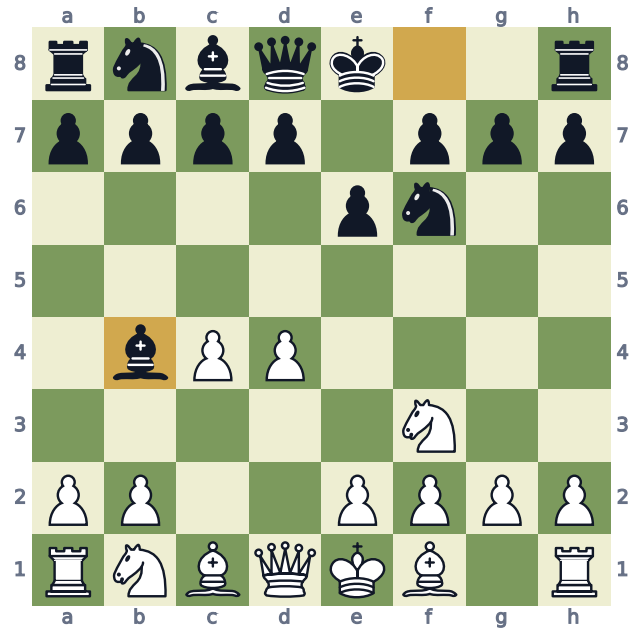
Neutralize the check and transpose toward a Catalan with flexible bishop choices.

MAIN DANGER

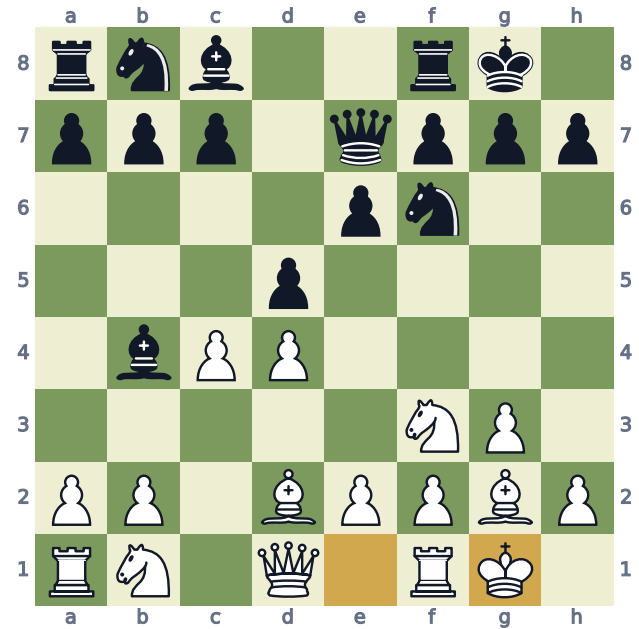
Bxb4 can help Black develop the queen or a-pawn depending on timing.

BRANCH LOGIC 04

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Keep the bishop if it has a future role; exchange only for a concrete gain.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

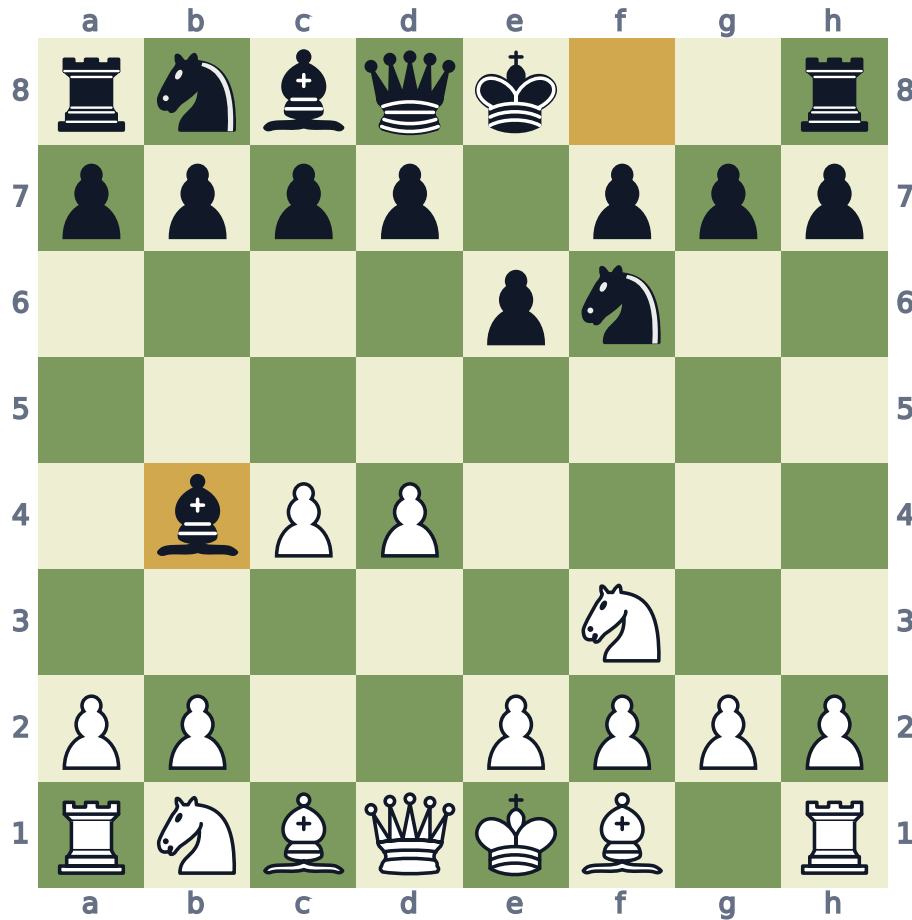
Position estimate: +0.59 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nbd7 Qc2 2. Bxd2 Nbx2 3. c5 Rfe1 4. b6 dxc5 5. bxc5 e4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 04

Bogo-Indian ...Qe7



YOUR TASK

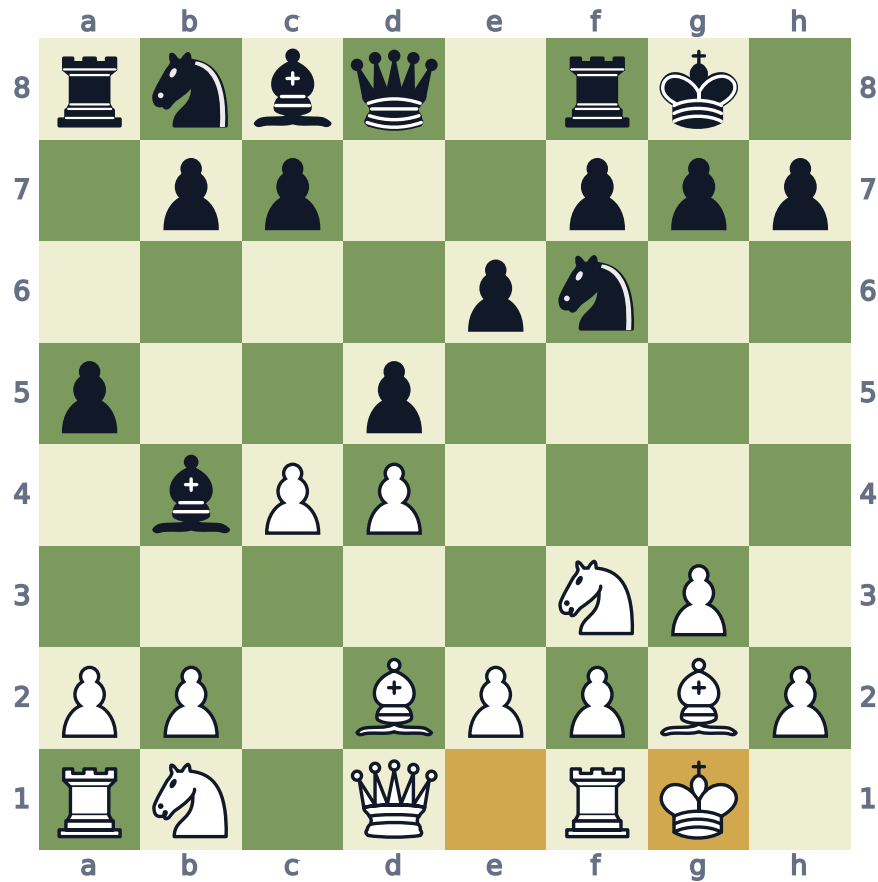
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 05

Bogo-Indian ...a5



COURSE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 Bb4+ 4. Bd2 a5 5. g3 d5 6. Bg2 O-O 7. O-O

WHITE'S IDEA

Develop calmly and question whether Black's bishop belongs on b4 or e7.

MAIN DANGER

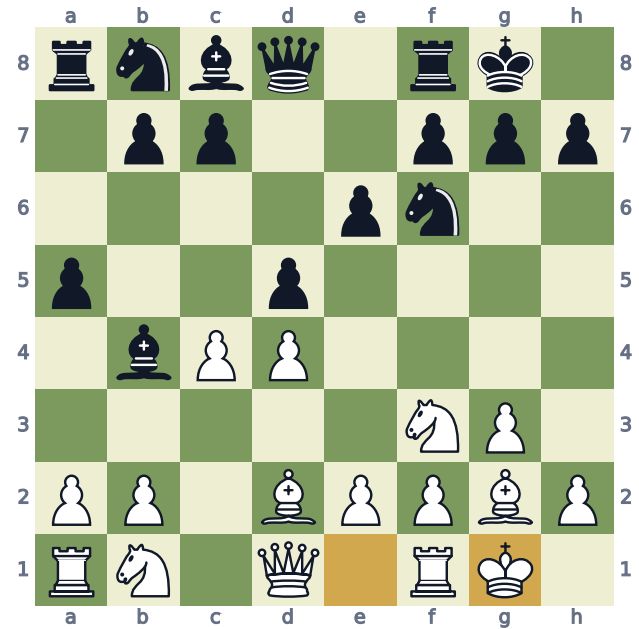
An early a3 can create a target and lose time.

BRANCH LOGIC 05

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

...a5 supports the bishop but also spends a tempo away from the center.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

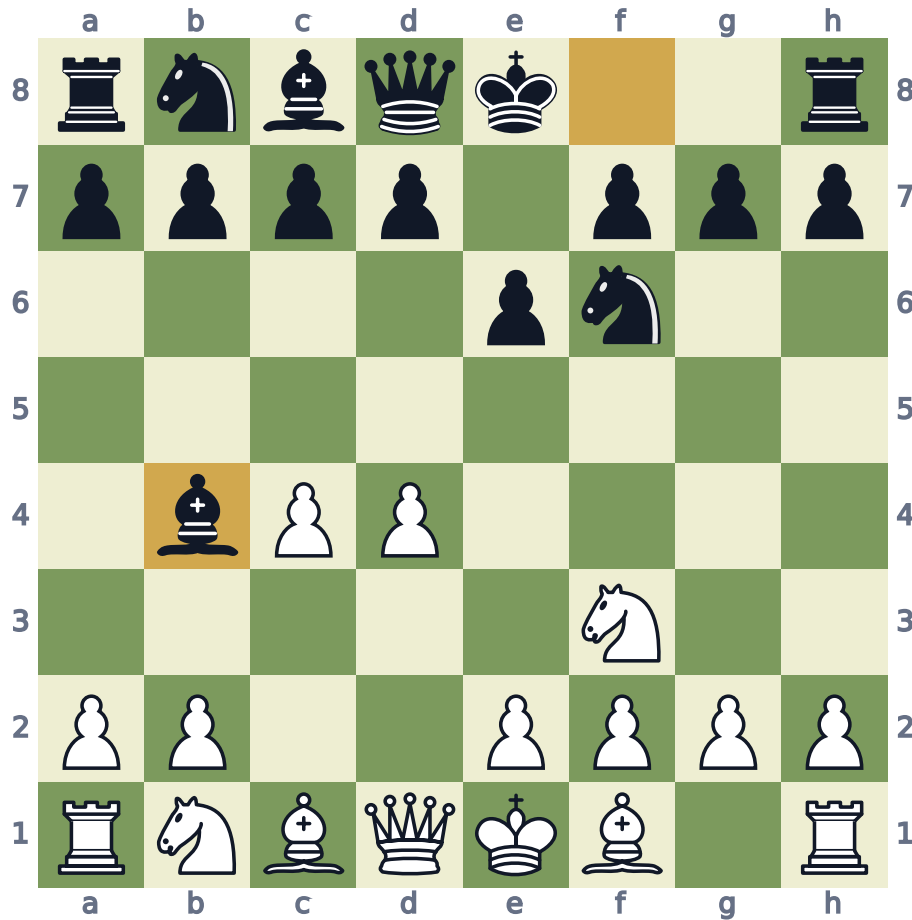
Position estimate: +0.16 for White (equal). Principal continuation: 1. dxc4 Qc2 2. Bxd2 Nbx2 3. b5 b3 4. cxb3 Nxb3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 05

Bogo-Indian ...a5



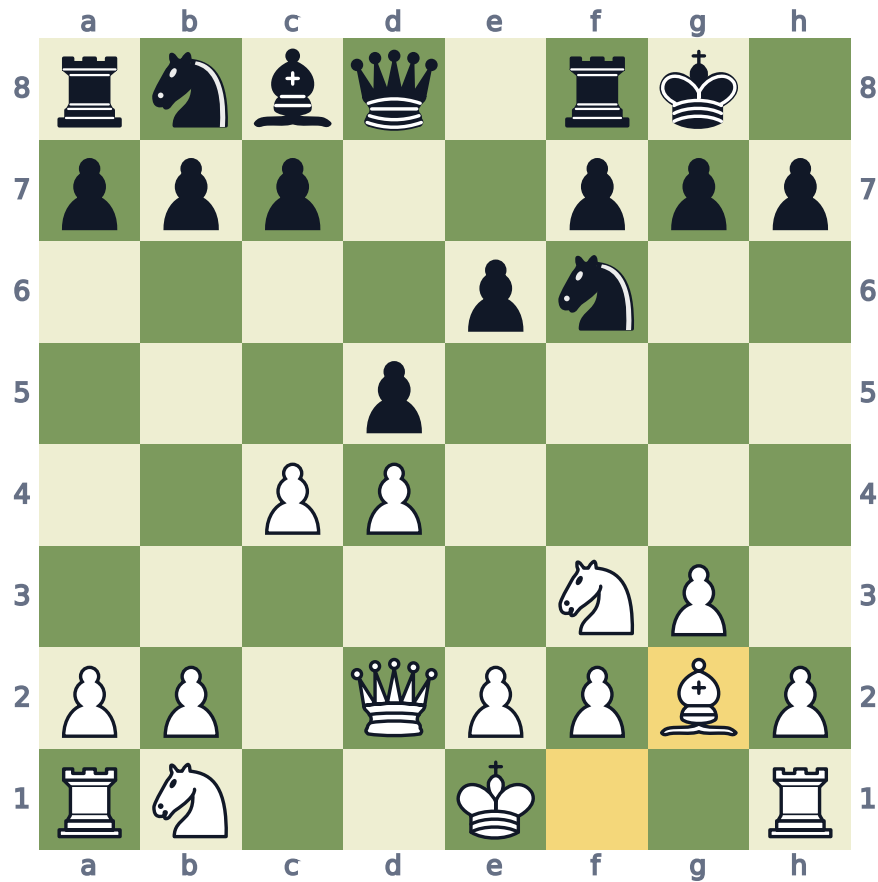
YOUR TASK

White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

Bogo-Indian ...Bxd2+



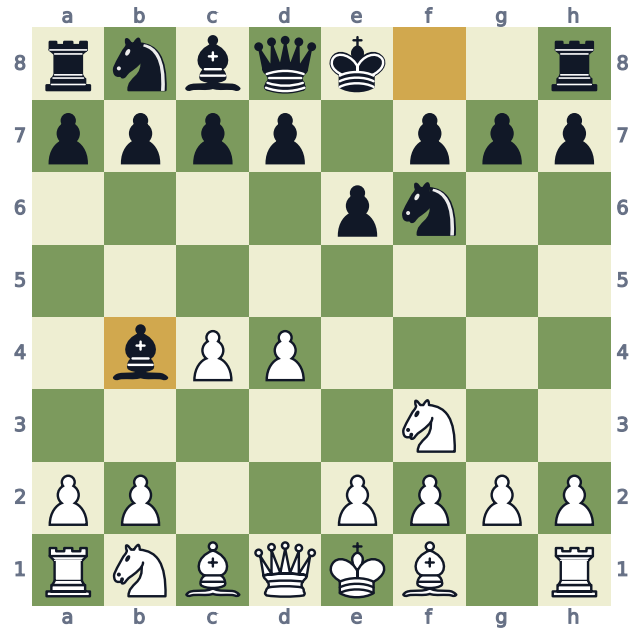
1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 Bb4+ 4. Bd2 Bxd2+ 5. Qxd2 d5 6. g3 O-O 7. Bg2

Use the queen actively and reach a Catalan-like structure without doubled pawns.

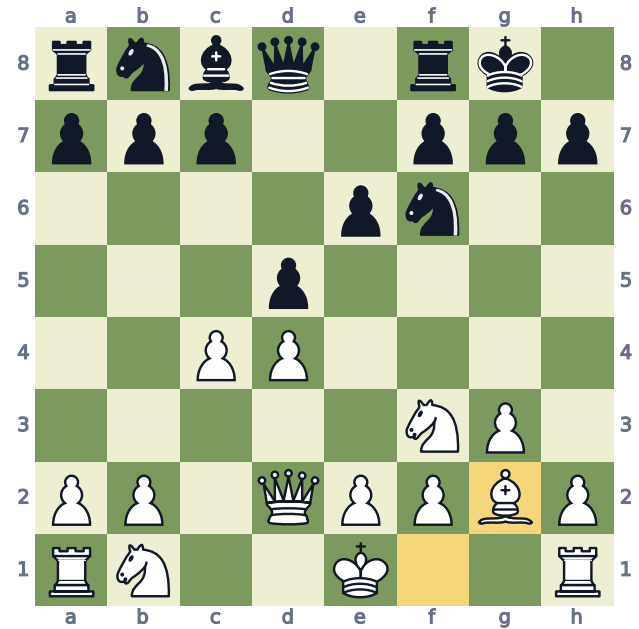
The queen may be hit by ...Ne4 or ...c5.

BRANCH LOGIC 06

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Qxd2 keeps the knight flexible and connects to c3/e3.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

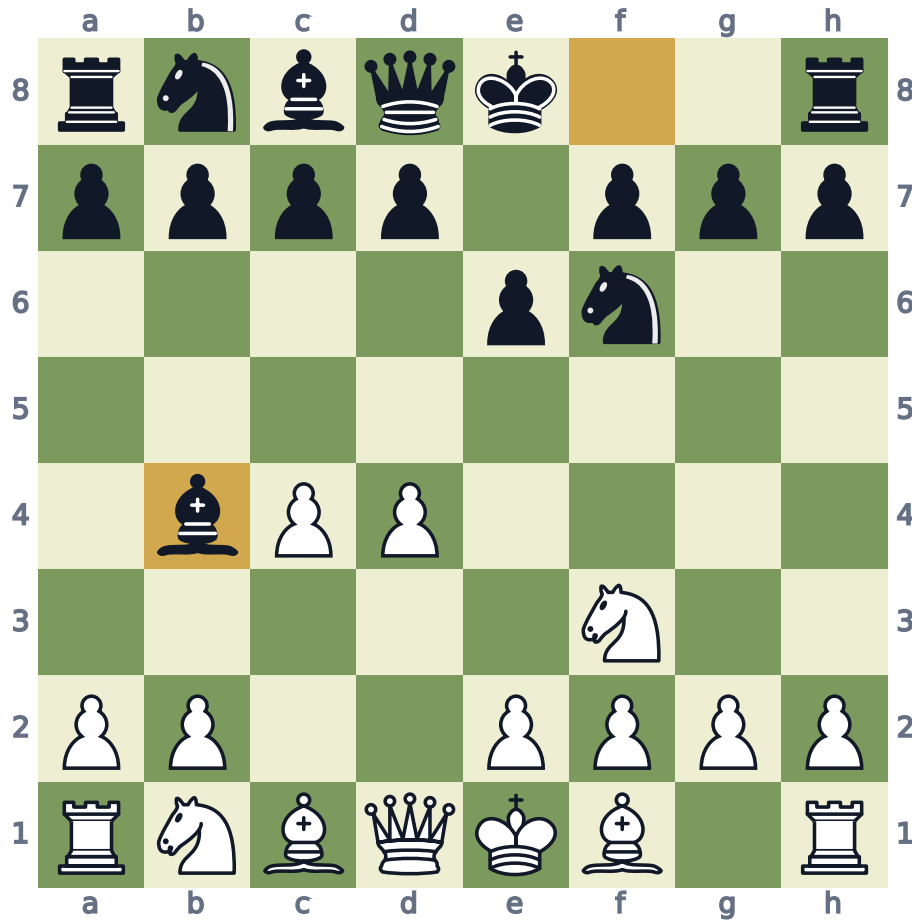
Position estimate: +0.43 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. c6 b3 2. Nbd7 O-O 3. b6 Rd1 4. Ba6 Ne5 5. Rc8

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 06

Bogo-Indian ...Bxd2+



YOUR TASK

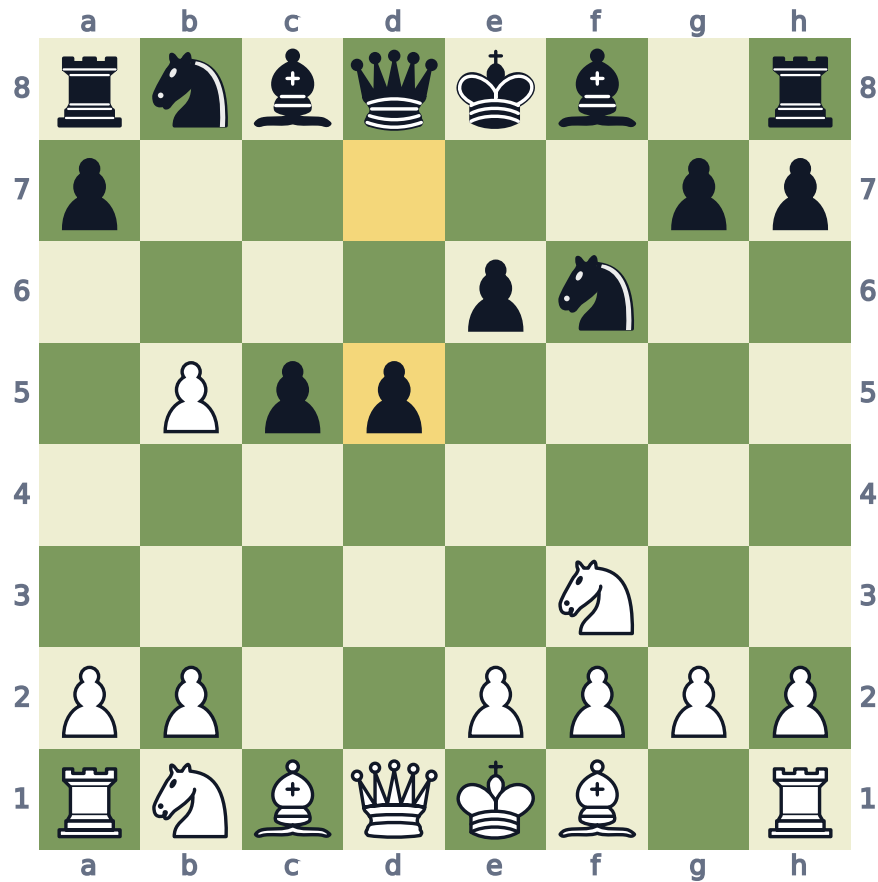
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 07

Blumenfeld Gambit



COURSE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 c5 4. d5 b5 5. dxe6 fxe6 6. cxb5 d5

WHITE'S IDEA

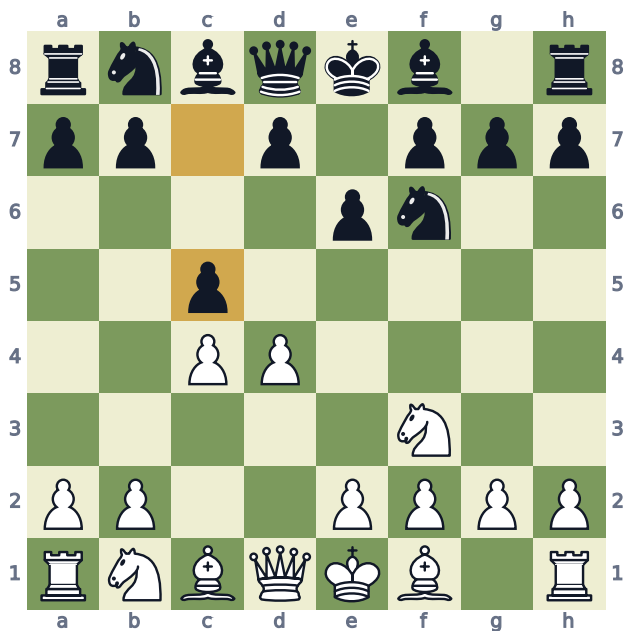
Return or consolidate material only after meeting Black's central activity.

MAIN DANGER

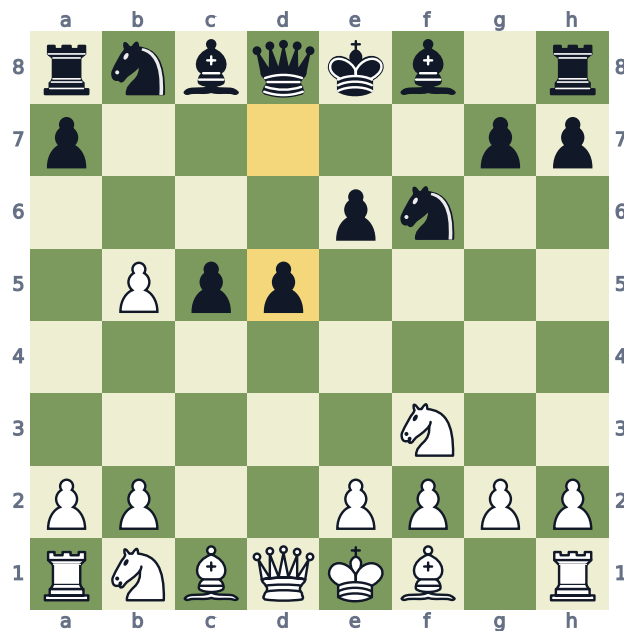
The e- and d-files can open against an uncastled king.

BRANCH LOGIC 07

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

...b5 plus ...e6 sacrifices a wing pawn to build a central mass.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

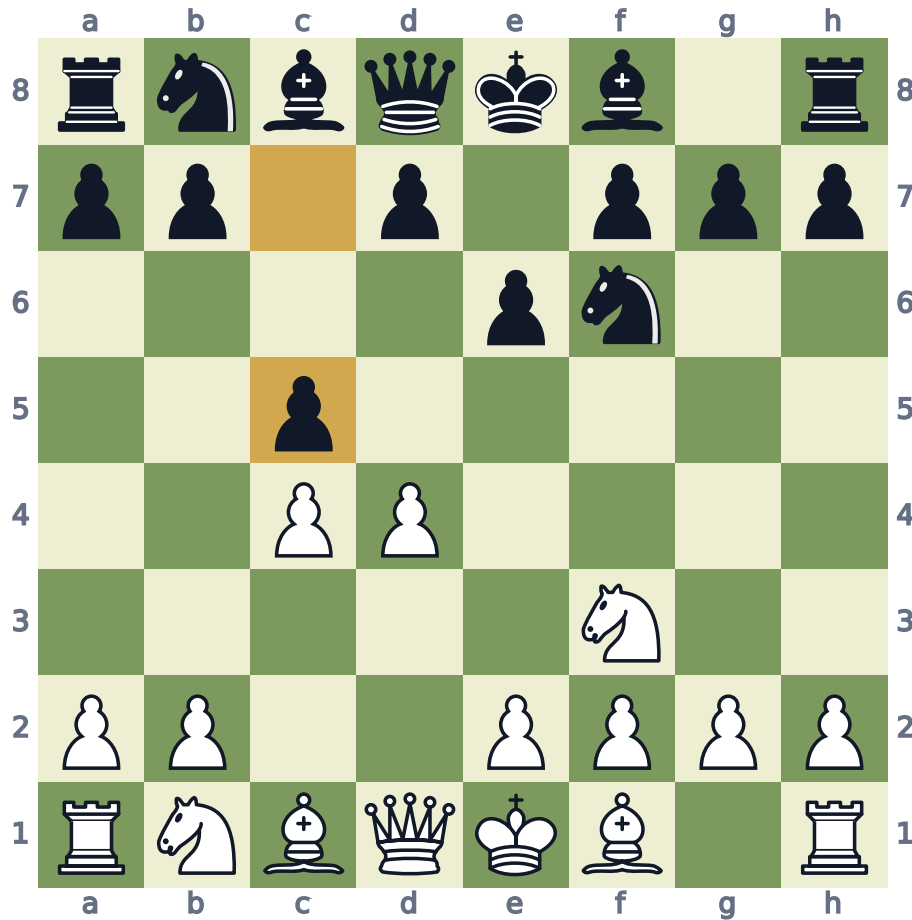
Position estimate: +0.79 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nc3 Be7 2. e4 d4 3. Na4 a6 4. b6 O-O

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 07

Blumenfeld Gambit



YOUR TASK

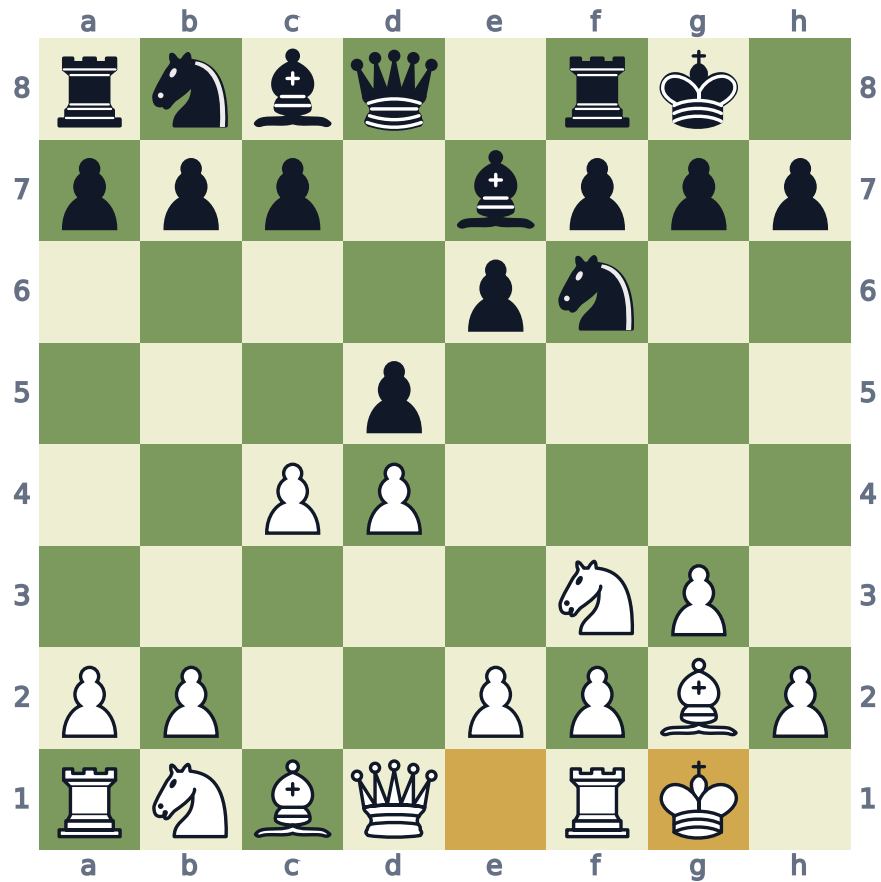
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 08

Nimzo avoidance



COURSE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nf3 d5 4. g3 Be7 5. Bg2 O-O 6. O-O

WHITE'S IDEA

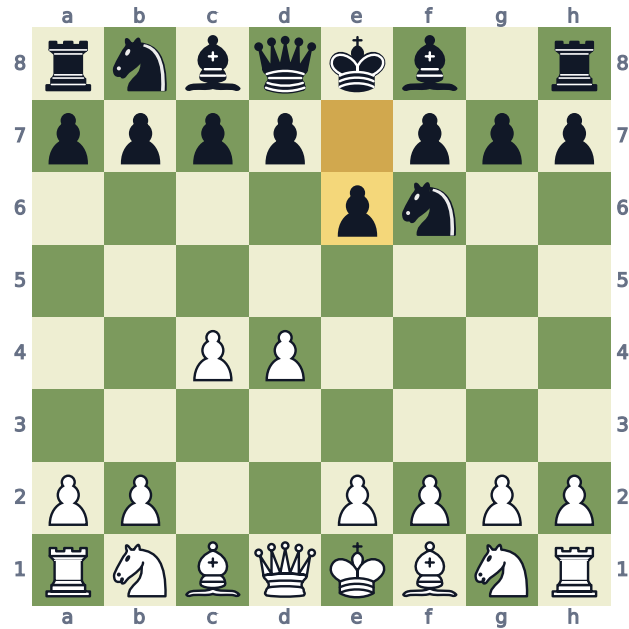
Use 3.Nf3 to keep a Catalan route and deny ...Bb4 as a Nimzo pin on Nc3.

MAIN DANGER

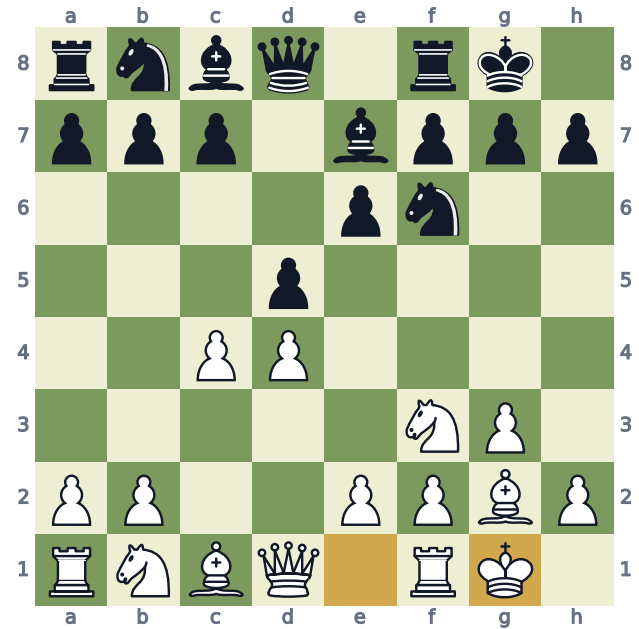
Avoidance has a price: some e4 setups develop more slowly.

BRANCH LOGIC 08

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

If you want to avoid the Nimzo, play Nf3 before Nc3 after ...e6.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

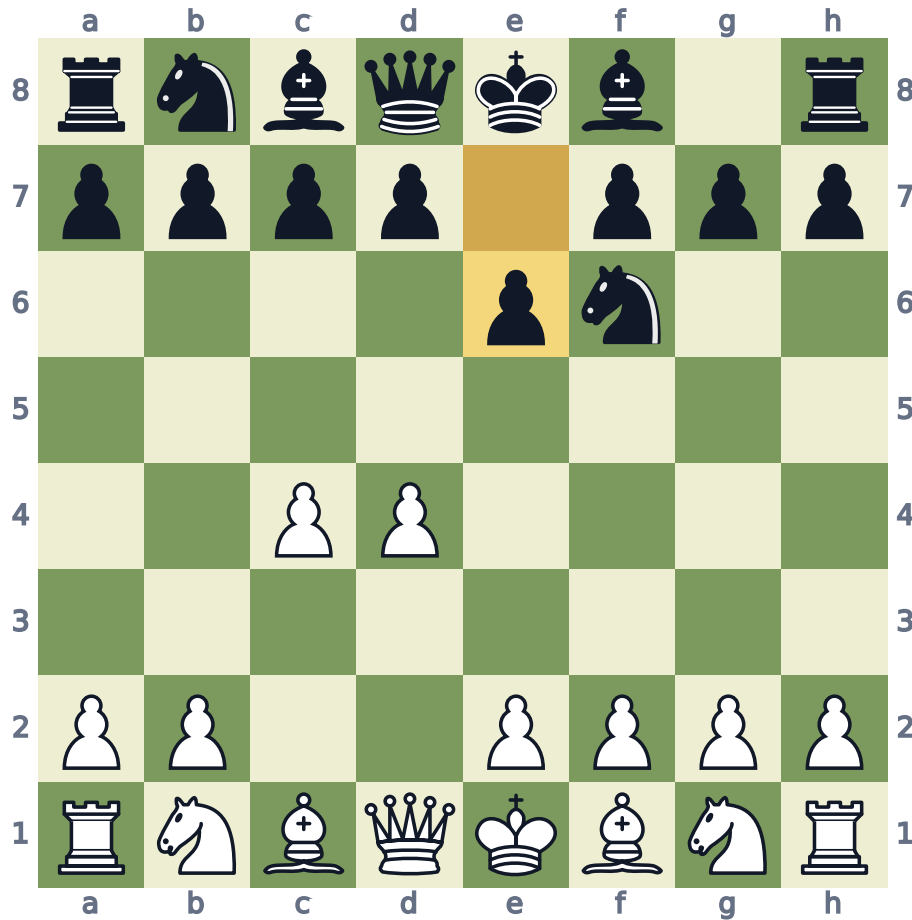
Position estimate: +0.48 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. a5 Nc3 2. Nbd7 b3 3. Ne4 Nxe4 4. dxe4 Ne5 5. c5 Bxe4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 08

Nimzo avoidance



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

ANSWER SECTION

Recall solutions begin here

PROTECT THE TRAINING EFFECT

Do not read a solution until you have committed to a move and purpose. A matching move without the correct reason earns partial credit. If the course move is not the engine's first choice, compare plans rather than treating the engine as a memorization oracle.

ERROR LABELS

M = move-order memory | T = tactical oversight | P = plan misunderstanding | V = visualization | C = calculation | R = rushed recognition

REPAIR RULE

Every miss must produce a question you can use in future games. Example: 'When Black supports d5 with c6, which pawn break or recovery method does my repertoire use?'

SOLUTIONS

Answers 1-3

01. QUEEN'S INDIAN ...BA6

Course move: g3. Purpose: Use b3 to protect c4 and force the bishop to declare its purpose. Engine comparison: 1. a3 Bb7 2. Nc3 d5 3. Bg5 Be7 4. cxd5 Nxd5 5. Bxe7 Qxe7 (+0.34 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: b3 weakens dark squares if White later loses the g2 bishop.

02. QUEEN'S INDIAN ...BB7

Course move: g3. Purpose: Finish development and test the centralized knight before occupying e4. Engine comparison: 1. a3 Bb7 2. Nc3 d5 3. Bg5 Be7 4. cxd5 Nxd5 5. Bxe7 Qxe7 (+0.34 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Careless d5 can leave c5 and e5 weak.

03. QUEEN'S INDIAN ...BB4+

Course move: g3. Purpose: Accept a useful queen placement and retain the bishop pair. Engine comparison: 1. a3 Bb7 2. Nc3 d5 3. Bg5 Be7 4. cxd5 Nxd5 5. Bxe7 Qxe7 (+0.34 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: The queen on d2 can block the b1 knight and invite ...Ne4.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 4-6

04. BOGO-INDIAN ...QE7

Course move: Bd2. Purpose: Neutralize the check and transpose toward a Catalan with flexible bishop choices. Engine comparison: 1. Nbd2 O-O 2. a3 Bxd2+ 3. Bxd2 b6 4. e3 Ne4 5. Bd3 (+0.43 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Bxb4 can help Black develop the queen or a-pawn depending on timing.

05. BOGO-INDIAN ...A5

Course move: Bd2. Purpose: Develop calmly and question whether Black's bishop belongs on b4 or e7. Engine comparison: 1. Nbd2 O-O 2. a3 Bxd2+ 3. Bxd2 b6 4. e3 Ne4 5. Bd3 (+0.43 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: An early a3 can create a target and lose time.

06. BOGO-INDIAN ...BXD2+

Course move: Bd2. Purpose: Use the queen actively and reach a Catalan-like structure without doubled pawns. Engine comparison: 1. Nbd2 O-O 2. a3 Bxd2+ 3. Bxd2 b6 4. e3 Ne4 5. Bd3 (+0.43 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: The queen may be hit by ...Ne4 or ...c5.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 7-8

07. BLUMENFELD GAMBIT

Course move: d5. Purpose: Return or consolidate material only after meeting Black's central activity. Engine comparison: 1. d5 b5 2. dxe6 fxe6 3. cxb5 a6 4. Nc3 axb5 5. e4 b4 (+0.76 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: The e- and d-files can open against an uncastled king.

08. NIMZO AVOIDANCE

Course move: Nf3. Purpose: Use 3.Nf3 to keep a Catalan route and deny ...Bb4 as a Nimzo pin on Nc3. Engine comparison: 1. g3 Bb4+ 2. Bd2 Be7 3. Qc2 c5 4. dxc5 Bxc5 5. Bg2 (+0.33 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Avoidance has a price: some e4 setups develop more slowly.

VOLUME REVIEW

Make the repertoire usable

REVIEW TASK 1

Reconstruct every branch from the first move without looking.

REVIEW TASK 2

For each branch, explain one Black plan and one White plan.

REVIEW TASK 3

Shuffle the recall positions so the chapter title cannot reveal the answer.

REVIEW TASK 4

Play each starting position against Fritz from both sides.

REVIEW TASK 5

Add mistakes from your own games to the PGN as new training positions.

REVIEW TASK 6

Retest the weakest three branches after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.

GRADUATION STANDARD

Score at least 80 percent twice, one week apart, and explain every move in plain language. Then maintain the volume through your own games instead of rereading it continuously.